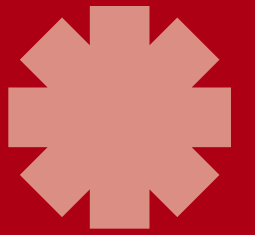


PRICING THE TALENT: WHAT IS A DATA SCIENTIST WORTH?

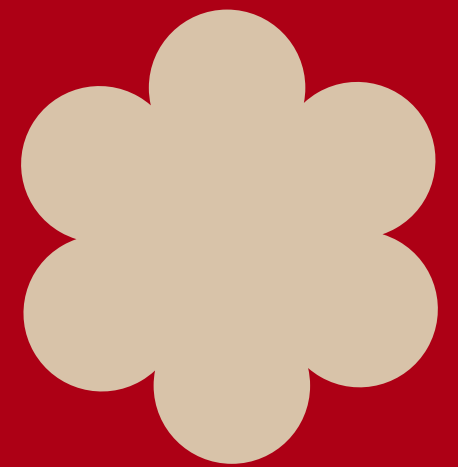
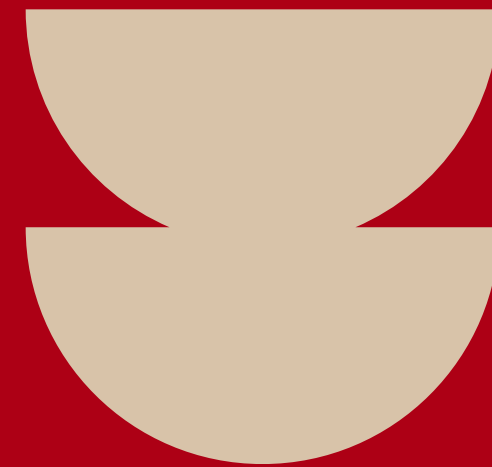
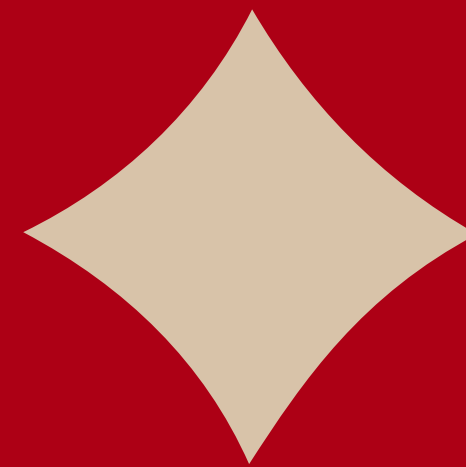


PRESENTED BY :

GerKayla Smalls

PRESENTED :

04 October 2026



WHAT SHOULD WE PAY OUR FIRST DATA
SCIENTIST AND FUTURE TEAM LEAD?

DATA & APPROACH

WHAT DOES THE DATA
TELL US?

	work_year	salary_in_usd
count	607.000000	607.000000
mean	2021.405272	112297.869852
std	0.692133	70957.259411
min	2020.000000	2859.000000
25%	2021.000000	62726.000000
50%	2022.000000	101570.000000
75%	2022.000000	150000.000000
max	2022.000000	600000.000000

1.

THE DATA SURVEYED
606 WORKING DATA
PROFESSIONALS
GLOBALLY BETWEEN
2020-2022.

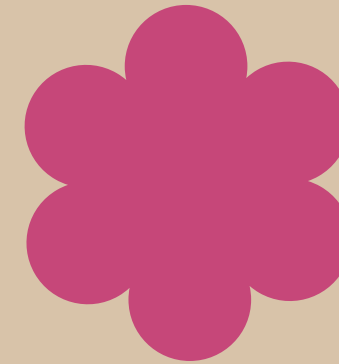
2.

PROFESSIONALS
OBSERVED HAD
EXPERIENCE LEVELS
FROM ENTRY-
EXECUTIVE

3.

THE AVERAGE DATA
PROFESSIONAL HAD A
SALARY OF ~\$112,297 .

THE MARKET BASELINE



WHY THE MEDIAN?

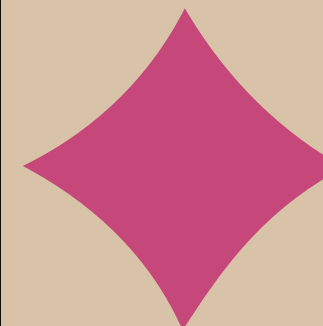
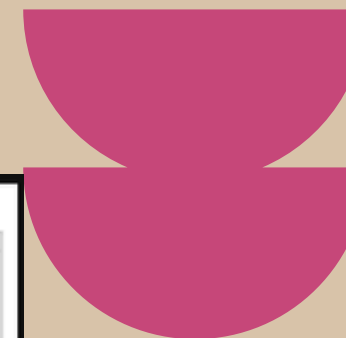
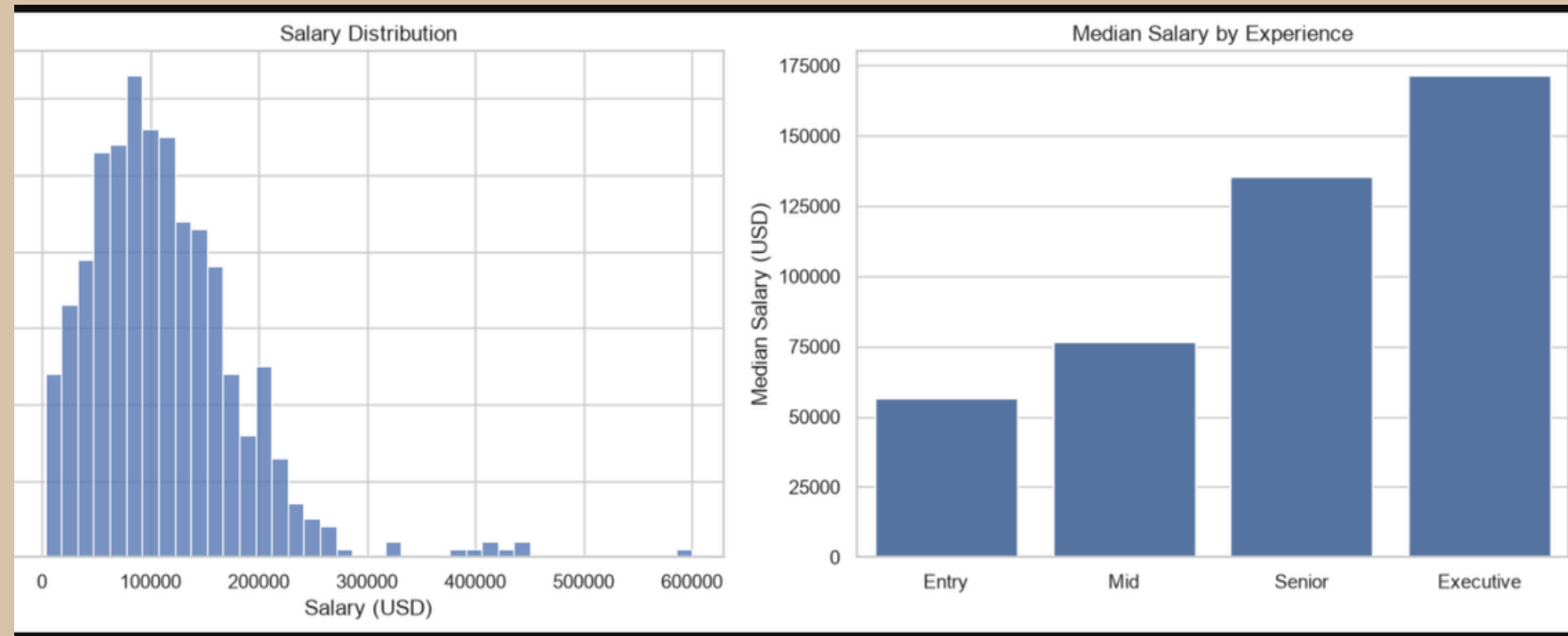
A median calculation was used here due to a right skew being present in the distribution. The median, in this case provides more clarity and accurate results. The grand majority of salaries cluster between \$50k and \$150k while a long tail trails to \$600k causing this skew. The group responsible for this is the smallest(executive) and only has about 26 people.

PAY CLIMBS WITH EXPERIENCE

As seen in the positively trending bar graph, there are higher median payouts for higher levels of experiences.. There is nearly a \$20k jump between entry-mid level. There is about a \$50k jump between mid and senior levels and close to \$40k from senior-executive.

SENIOR EARNERS

A huge note to take here is that the biggest jump in salary happens between mid - senior level. Senior level professionals also make up the most of the population in the data so their data is very solid.



THE US PREMIUM



US

It is no mistake in both graphs that US professionals are earning more than offshore professionals. Competitive pay for US earners is \$140k-\$175k. Though the gap may look huge comparatively, the p-value calculation being so close to 0 shows that this evidence is very accurate.

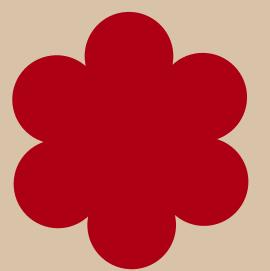
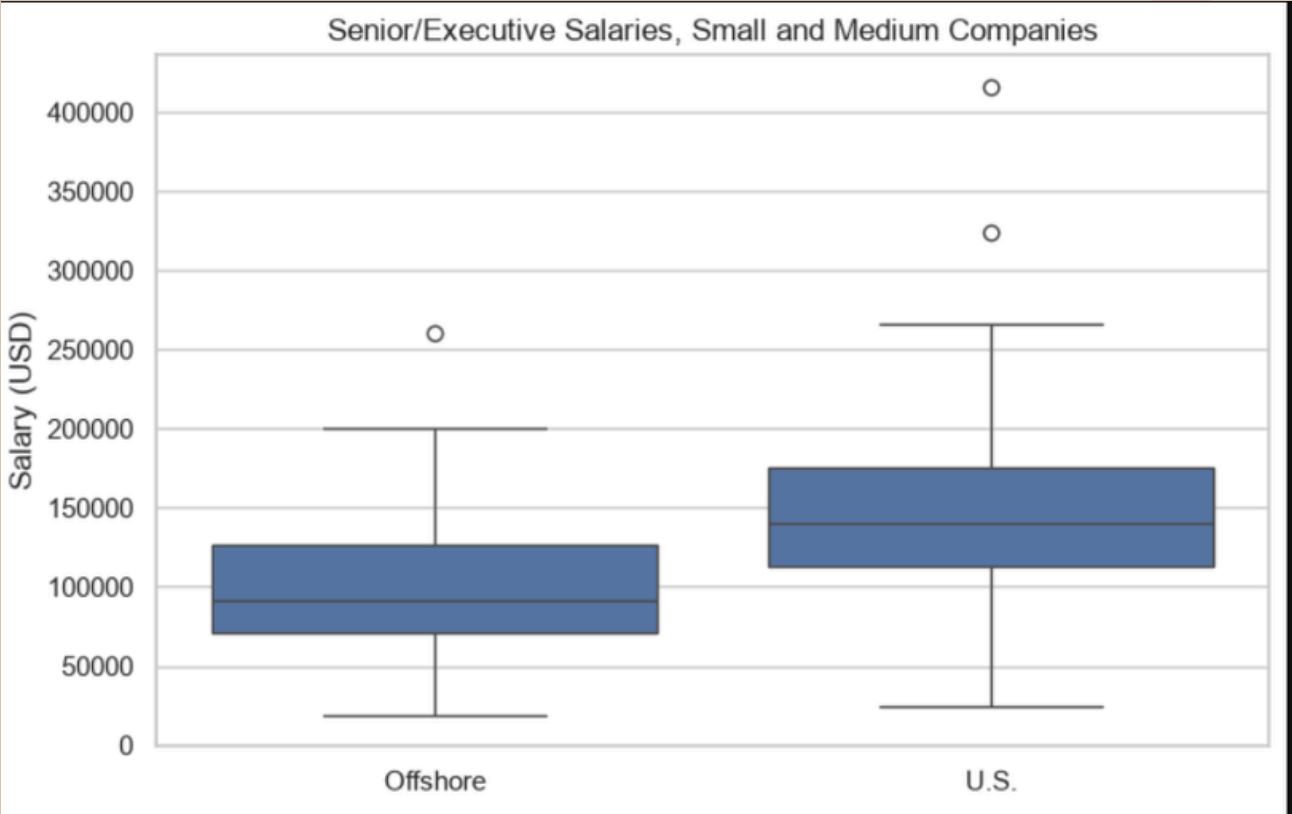
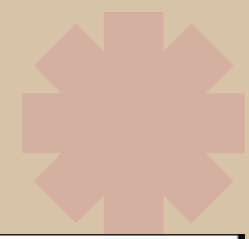
OFFSHORE

It is pretty evident in both graphs that Offshore professionals earn less than US professionals. However, this should be taken with the country's cost of living in mind comparative to the pay. In general, competitive pay looks like \$90.9k-\$126.3k for this group.



**THE US
PREMIUM
IS ABOUT
121%**

RECOMMENDED SALARY RANGES



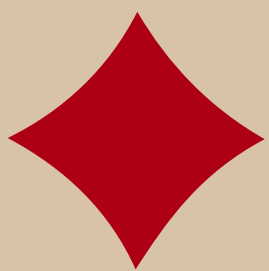
1. Key Findings Effecting Pay

U.S. hires require a larger budget, with pay about 115% above offshore. Seniority adds more, at roughly 98% over entry level for senior roles. Small companies pay about 18% less than large ones, so we must compete beyond base salary. Remote work has no measurable effect on pay.



2. A Competitive Offer

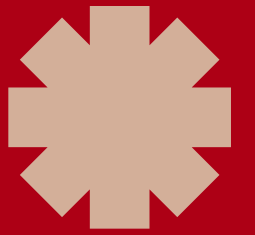
A competitive offer sits around the 50-75th percentile. For US professionals, this looks like \$140,000 - \$175,050 and Offshore this looks like \$90,968 - \$126,250 . These ranges are appropriate for catching the eye of qualified individuals that are able to work solidly alone and help lead a team in the future.



3. Reserve Top Pay for Top Talent

Top talent earns more than the average and will also need a bigger budget set for them. An appropriate range for this group would lay in the 75-90th percentile. This looks likes \$126,250 - \$164,272 for Offshore professionals and \$175,050 - \$210,900 for US professionals.

CONCLUSION



Key Takeaways:

- Location is the biggest cost factor. U.S. pay is higher than offshore, so the hiring location largely sets the budget.
- Seniority commands a premium. Senior roles pay about 98% more than entry level, and executives about 206% more, which supports hiring at the senior level for a future team lead.
- We compete from a disadvantage. Small companies pay about 18% less than large ones, so a competitive base salary should be paired with equity, growth opportunities, or flexibility.
- Remote work doesn't change pay, so we can widen our search without raising the offer.

Limitations:

- The data is self-reported and excludes bonuses and equity.
- The model explains about half of salary variation ($R^2 = 0.49$), and "offshore" combines many countries with very different pay levels.

Next Steps:

- Decide between a U.S. and offshore hire based on budget and team needs.
- Plan compensation bands now for the team we expect to build.